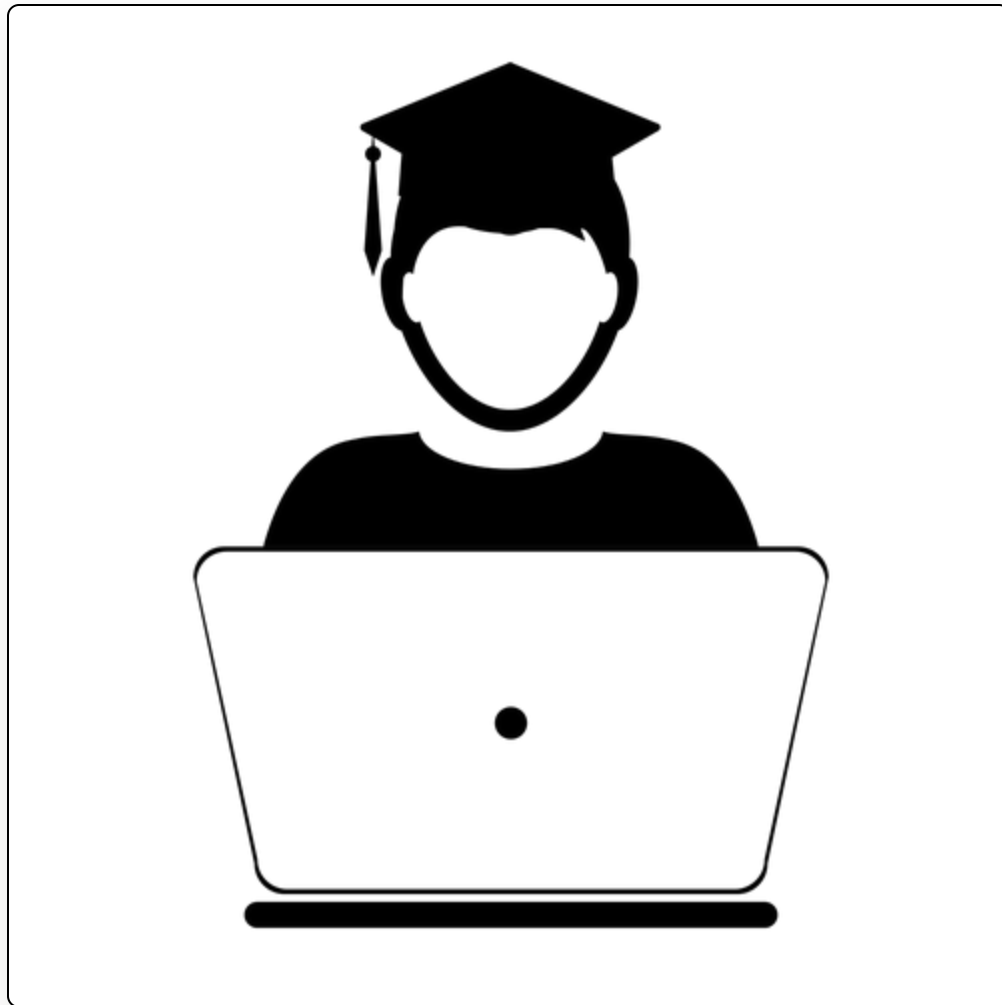


Chapter Two: Self-Canonisation, Literary-Historical Fictions and Aesthetic Critique

Cite as: Martin Paul Eve, "Chapter Two: Self-Canonisation, Literary-Historical Fictions and Aesthetic Critique", *eve.gd: Martin Paul Eve*, February 22, 2015, <https://doi.org/10.59348/ct0q8-cf277>.



A map, as of the 22nd February 2015, of Chapter Two of [the book I am slowly working on](#).

Mimetic representation academy not only possible interaction Intertextuality can be seen as academy-like function of (self-)canonisation

Tom McCarthy's *C*

University English haunts text

Public persona of author as popular literary critic

Synopsis of *C*

Inter-textuality key to novel and its marketing

Thomas Pynchon

Melanie Jackson as literary agent

Novel situates itself within postmodern lineage

Taxonomies

Novel attempts to canonise itself

Usurps supposed function of university English

C's metafictional histories are also literary histories

C is not the only text to do this

Bechdel's *Fun Home*

Franzen's *Freedom*

But good example of overlap with university practice

Structures

“Difficulty”

Ludic mode

Micro-prolepsis

Epistemic play (core to all novels)

Differentiated repetition

Intra-diegetic representation of text's own approach to
literary history

Proliferation of -modernisms as symptom

Implies loops and alternative time structure but is actually
linear

C as historical novel?

“60-year rule” (relative periodisation)

“Accuracy” (generic conventions)

“Experience” (research)

“Suspension of disbelief” (dissonance)

Flawed premises of historical novel

Relative periodisation and research criteria incompatible with
anti-humanism

Generic conventions rely on historical imaginary

Raises historiographic questions

Epistemic isolation

C is a literary-historical novel

Tradition of Luddite fiction

Almost-repetitious/analogous;

Almost-historiographic

Almost-critical

Signposts

C's metatextual features

The implied archive

Kempf's dogfight

The implied archive signposts (postmodern) historical fiction

Mark Z. Danielewski's *House of Leaves*

Academic prose style

Subversion of verification

Harold Bloom

Anxieties of influence

Canon wars

Anagrams as ludic mode

C's signals of itself as metafiction

Proto-facticity that implies the archive

Linguistic play that generates metafictional awareness

Plays

Woolf

Pynchon

Ballard

Atrocity Exhibition

Subjunctivity

DeLillo

White Noise

Photography

Realism

Conclusion

C is metafictional

C situates itself in various lineages through intertextuality

C has qualities of the historical novel

This becomes a text about literary histories/histories of genre

This self-situation has an academy-like function

Or at least betrays an influential anxiety of academia